
ST. BERNADETTE'S '09 ASSOCIATION

St. Bernadette's Junior High School | Tafo Nhyiaeso, Kumasi, Ghana



CONSTITUTION

UNITY | SUPPORT | PROGRESS

Year Group: 2009

Slogan: One Year Group, One Family

Designed by David Banahene

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Article 1: Name of the Association	3
Article 2: Location	3
Article 3: Motto, Slogan, and Logo	3
Article 4: Aims and Objectives	4
Article 5: Membership	4
Article 6: Member in Good Standing	4
Article 7: Financial Obligations	5
Article 8: Welfare and Benefits	5
Article 9: Organs of the Association	5
Article 10: Executive Officers	5
Article 11: Duties of Officers	6
Article 12: Tenure of Office	6
Article 13: Election of Officers	6
Article 14: Meetings	7
Article 15: Quorum	7
Article 16: Decision Making	7
Article 17: Finance and Accountability	7
Article 18: Discipline	7
Article 19: Forfeiture of Benefits	8
Article 20: Interim Executives	8
Article 21: Records and Register	8
Article 22: Amendment of the Constitution	8
Article 23: Interpretation	8
Article 24: Adoption	9

CONSTITUTION OF ST. BERNADETTE'S '09 ASSOCIATION

This Constitution is made to guide the affairs of St. Bernadette's '09 Association in a simple, fair, and orderly way. It is written to help members understand their rights, duties, financial commitments, welfare benefits, and the general administration of the group.

Article 1: Name of the Association

1. The name of the Association shall be St. Bernadette's '09 Association, hereinafter referred to as "the Association."

Article 2: Location

1. The Association traces its origin to St. Bernadette's Junior High School, Tafo Nhyiaeso, Kumasi, Ghana.

Article 3: Motto, Slogan, and Logo

1. The Association may adopt a motto and slogan with the approval of members at a general meeting.
2. The Association shall have a logo for identification and official use.
3. Until a final logo is approved, the interim executives may use the Association's name in a simple official design for letters, notices, and documents.
4. The logo, when adopted, shall appear on the Association's documents, forms, and notices.
5. Suggested Motto: Unity, Support and Progress.
6. Suggested Slogan: One Year Group, One Family.

Article 4: Aims and Objectives

1. To promote unity, friendship, and cooperation among members.
2. To support members in times of need according to the rules of the Association.
3. To encourage commitment, discipline, and active participation among members.
4. To provide a platform for discussion and group decisions.
5. To promote the welfare and progress of members.
6. To uphold the good name of our former school and year group.
7. To build a strong and lasting Association for present and future benefit.
8. To attend programs and events that promote the welfare of the Association, both within and outside the region.
9. To delegate two or three members to represent the Association at programs and events outside the region.

Article 5: Membership

1. Membership shall be open to persons who were part of St. Bernadette's 2009 year group.
2. A person becomes a recognized member when he or she is accepted by the Association, provides his or her details for registration, and agrees to obey this Constitution.
3. The Association shall keep a register of members with details such as full name, phone number, town or city of residence, next of kin, the contact details of a close relative or emergency contact person, and names of parents, spouse, and children for welfare purposes.
4. Membership is a binding commitment. A member may not unilaterally cease to be a member after receiving benefits from the Association. Any member who does so may be subject to legal action to recover benefits received or to enforce obligations owed.
5. The Association may, with the approval of members, admit honorary or associate members where necessary, but such persons shall not vote unless the Association decides otherwise.

Article 6: Member in Good Standing

1. A member shall be considered in good standing when he or she has paid the commitment fee, pays monthly dues and welfare contributions as agreed, obeys the rules of the Association, does not bring the Association into disrepute, and participates actively in meetings and group activities.
 2. A member shall maintain active participation and high attendance at regional programs and activities of the Association.
 3. Only members in good standing shall enjoy full benefits, voting rights, and eligibility to hold office.
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Article 7: Financial Obligations

1. Every member shall pay a commitment fee of GH¢100.00.
 2. Every member shall pay monthly dues of GH¢20.00.
 3. Every member shall pay a contribution of GH¢50.00 as agreed by the Association for welfare purposes.
 4. The Association may review these amounts from time to time at a general meeting.
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Article 8: Welfare and Benefits

1. The Association shall provide official support only in the following cases: death of a member; death of a member's mother; death of a member's father; death of a member's spouse; and death of a member's child.
 2. All other matters, including sickness and similar situations, shall be handled through voluntary contributions unless the Association later decides otherwise.
 3. A member shall qualify for official support only if the member is in good standing and the matter is reported to the Association within a reasonable time.
 4. A member who refuses to obey the Constitution, refuses to honor agreed payments without acceptable reason, or acts against the decisions of the Association may lose part or all of the benefits of the Association until the matter is resolved.
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Article 9: Organs of the Association

1. The organs of the Association shall be the General Meeting, the Executive Committee, and any sub-committee or ad hoc committee approved by the Association.
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Article 10: Executive Officers

1. The officers of the Association shall be: President, Vice President, General Secretary, Assistant Secretary, Treasurer, Financial Secretary, Organizer, Welfare Officer, and a Public Relations Officer, where necessary.
 2. The Association may combine some roles if the membership size makes that more practical.
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Article 11: Duties of Officers

1. The President shall lead the Association, chair meetings, ensure that this Constitution is followed, work with the Secretary to prepare the agenda, and represent the Association in official matters.
2. The Vice President shall assist the President, act in the absence of the President, and perform any duty assigned by the President or the Association.
3. The General Secretary shall record minutes, keep records and correspondence, keep the register of members, issue notices of meetings, and keep official documents of the Association.
4. The Assistant Secretary shall assist the General Secretary and act in his or her absence.
5. The Treasurer shall keep proper records of all money received and spent, collect dues together with the Financial Secretary, keep receipts and payment records, present statements of accounts at meetings, and ensure Association funds are kept secure.
6. The Financial Secretary shall record all money due and paid by members and assist the Treasurer in financial reporting.
7. The Organizer shall help arrange meetings and events, mobilize members for activities, and assist with planning.
8. The Welfare Officer shall receive welfare information from members, verify welfare cases, and advise the executives on welfare support to be given under this Constitution.
9. The Public Relations Officer shall manage the public image of the Association, handle communications with external bodies, coordinate publicity for events, and promote the activities and welfare of members to the public.

Article 12: Tenure of Office

1. Executive officers shall hold office for two (2) years.
2. An officer may be re-elected for one more term only.
3. No person shall hold two executive offices at the same time.
4. Any officer who resigns shall inform the Association in writing.

Article 13: Election of Officers

1. Elections shall be held at a general meeting on a date approved by the Association.
 2. Only members in good standing may vote or contest for office.
 3. Nominations shall be made and seconded by members in good standing.
 4. Voting may be by show of hands, secret ballot, or any fair method approved by members.
 5. In case of a tie, there shall be a re-vote.
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Article 14: Meetings

1. The Association shall hold general meetings at times agreed by members.
2. Meetings may be held physically or through online platforms such as WhatsApp audio call, phone call, or any other agreed medium.
3. Emergency meetings may be called by the executives where necessary.
4. Notice of meetings shall be given to members in good time.

Article 15: Quorum

1. One-third (1/3) of active members in good standing shall form a quorum for a general meeting.
2. Where a quorum is not met, the meeting may be adjourned and reconvened on another date.
3. Decisions shall generally be taken by simple majority of members present and voting.

Article 16: Decision Making

1. Every member in good standing has the right to speak and vote at meetings.
2. Unless otherwise stated, decisions shall be by simple majority.
3. The chairperson shall have a casting vote where necessary.

Article 17: Finance and Accountability

1. The Association shall operate a bank account or approved mobile money account in the name of the Association when practicable.
2. Association funds shall not be kept privately without proper records.
3. At least two officers shall be signatories or approving officers for withdrawals or transfers.
4. The Treasurer shall present a statement of accounts at general meetings.
5. The Association may appoint two or three members to audit or review the accounts from time to time.

Article 18: Discipline

1. A member may be cautioned, suspended from benefits, or sanctioned if he or she disobeys the Constitution, insults or undermines the Association or its officers without just cause, misuses Association funds or property, refuses to comply with agreed obligations, or engages in misconduct that disrupts the peace of the Association.
 2. Before any sanction is applied, the member shall be informed of the complaint, given the chance to explain, and the final decision shall be communicated to the member.
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Article 19: Forfeiture of Benefits

1. Any member who has accepted this Constitution but willfully refuses to obey it may forfeit welfare support and any other benefits of the Association during the period of default or disciplinary action.
2. A member under disciplinary review may also lose voting rights until the matter is settled.
3. Benefits may be restored when the member complies and the Association accepts the member back into good standing.

Article 20: Interim Executives

1. Until full elections are conducted under this Constitution, the interim executives shall continue to manage the affairs of the Association, help implement this Constitution, and communicate important decisions to members.

Article 21: Records and Register

1. The Association shall keep a register of members, minutes book or digital minutes file, cash book or financial record, welfare record, copies of notices and official communications, and signed member acceptance forms.

Article 22: Amendment of the Constitution

1. This Constitution may be amended at a general meeting.
2. Notice of the proposed amendment shall be given before the meeting.
3. An amendment shall be approved by not less than two-thirds (2/3) of members present and voting.

Article 23: Interpretation

1. Where there is doubt about the meaning of any part of this Constitution, the executives shall first interpret it, subject to the approval of the general meeting.
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Article 24: Adoption

1. This Constitution shall take effect from the date it is adopted by the members of St. Bernadette's '09 Association.

Adopted by: St. Bernadette's '09 Association

Date of Adoption: _____

President: _____

General Secretary: _____